

EDU401 - Contemporary Issues and Trends in Education

GDB Solution

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Formal, Informal, and Non-formal Learning in Higher Education

Formal learning is defined as the learning which occurs within some organizational framework and this framework will involve schools, universities, colleges and any sort of training institutions. It is academic and normally involves a teacher or some form of instructor and results in certifications or degrees. This way, in Higher Education, formality guarantees academic quality and an organized system of knowledge evaluation, which provides discipline-specified proficiency.

In contrast, **informal learning** is acquired incidental to interactions, behaviors, and occurrences in the normal course of life. It's not quite systematic it is not categorized and there aren't any tests or exams on the knowledge acquired. Informal learning in higher education may involve learning from other students, engagement in co curricular activities or individual learning from other sources. Still, it remains uncredited as such and is highly significant when it comes to cultivating problem-solving skills, imagination, and life experiences.

The position of **non-formal** learning is between the formal and informal learning. It is generally structured and conducted away from the school or formal classroom setting like workshops or a Web based class or a community education program. Formal learning is rigid when compared to non-formal learning that provides a chance for education throughout life. In the context of higher education, non-formal learning can positively enrich or supplement formal education, which can equip learners with competencies for employment or further learning and personal development.

Implications for Higher Education: The combination of the three types of learning in higher education institutions can thus improve students' learning experience. Main categories of learning can be divided into five following categories, where formal learning gives information and knowledge and informal/non-formal learning offer skills, self-motivation, and flexibility. A combination of all three can result to graduates that are both academically sound as well as functionally competent and possess renal learning abilities.

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